

Kian Kyars

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Education

BSc Computer Science, Honours - University of Alberta

C/O 2025 *Grade: 3.9/4.0*

Experience

fr8 Cohort 1.0

June 2025 - August 2025

- Developing the [Factorio Learning Environment](#): an open-ended LLM benchmark focused on system engineering for AI agents

Data-Driven Network and Cyber Security (DANS) Lab

September 2024 - June

Undergraduate Research Assistant

2025

- Finetuned Qwen2.5, Llama 3, and DeepSeek R1 7-8B models with unsloth for provenance graph construction
- Performed adaptive anomaly detection locally on system logs with equivalent performance to GPT-4o

MANGA NLP Lab

January 2025 - April 2025

Undergraduate Research Assistant

- Re-implemented Flora: a low-rank adaptation optimizer using random projections for gradient compression
- Empirical training speed increases up to 25% compared to LoRA w/ AdamW in 3B and 7B parameter LLMs

Hochschule für Technik und Wirtschaft Dresden

May 2023 - August 2023

Summer Research Intern

- DAAD RISE Intern in reinforcement learning on the 7-DOF Franka Emika Robot arm
- Trained using Nvidia Omniverse Isaac Sim to perform block manipulation tasks using TRPO and PPO

Projects

SmolLM3 from Scratch

July 2025

- Re-implemented and trained SmolLM3 on an 8xV100 cluster with 3D parallelism

Hugging Face Ultra Scale Playbook Series

June 2025

- Created a [16-part video series](#) covering the Hugging Face Ultra Scale Playbook to teach myself large-scale GPU orchestration through teaching others, recognized by Hugging Face CSO Thomas Wolf

Founder - UofA Run Club (UofARC)

August 2024 - April 2025

- Created a weekly run club to gather community members together bright and early

Founder - UofACarpool

March 2024 - April 2025

- Wrote algorithm and website for matching service that pairs university commuters to carpool together
- Featured on the [University Newspaper](#)

Extracurricular

German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD)

August 2024 - July 2025

Young Ambassador

- Chosen as the unique ambassador of the DAAD for the UofA

Interests

- Avid language learner (French and German) and runner (longest distance: 50 kilometers)